

Xinyuan Yang

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🌐 <https://xinyuanyang.github.io>

Education

American University <i>PhD in Political Science</i>	<i>Sept 2022 – Present</i>
◦ Research Area Political Methodology, Computational Social Science, Comparative Politics ◦ Committee Jeff Gill (Chair), Tongtong Zhang, Ryan T. Moore, Gary King (External)	
Harvard University <i>Visiting Graduate Student, Teaching Fellow</i>	<i>Sept 2024 – May 2025</i>
American University <i>MS in Data Analytics</i>	<i>Sept 2020 – May 2022</i>
University of Wisconsin - Madison <i>BA in Political Science</i>	<i>Sept 2015 – May 2019</i>

Research Interests

- Political Methodology: Bayesian Nonparametric Model, Spatial Temporal Model, Survey Methodology, Machine Learning
- Comparative Politics: Conflict, Political Economy

Selected Work in Progress

1. A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Framework for Predicting Conflict Intensity
Xinyuan Yang
2. How Does Chinese Foreign Development Finance Incite Conflict in Sub-Saharan Africa
Xinyuan Yang
3. A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data (under review at *Political Science Research and Methods*)
Xinyuan Yang, Jeff Gill
4. Dynamic Contrastive Contextual Embedding for Ideal Points Estimation
Yuki Mikiya (Keio University), Kentaro Nakamura (Harvard University), **Xinyuan Yang**

Conferences

<i>A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. American Political Science Association (APSA)</i>	<i>September (Scheduled), 2026</i>
<i>A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. 2026 International Symposium on Spatiotemporal Data Science</i>	<i>August (Scheduled), 2026</i>
<i>A Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Predicting Conflict Intensity. Polmeth 2026</i>	<i>July, 2026</i>
<i>A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data. Southern Political Science Association Annual Conference</i>	<i>January, 2026</i>
<i>A New Information Criterion for Machine Learning and Big Data. Latin American Political Methodology Annual Meeting</i>	<i>November, 2025</i>
<i>Bayesian Spatiotemporal Methodology for Prediction of Conflict in Sub Saharan</i>	<i>July, 2025</i>

Grant and Scholarships

AY2026-2027 SPA PhD Student Funding Award	<i>\$28000</i>
Polmeth Travel Grant 2025	<i>\$500</i>
Neil and Ann Kerwin Doctoral Fellowship 2025	<i>\$10000</i>
EITM Certificate Scholarship Summer 2023	
Kogod School of Business Merit Scholarship 2020 - 2021	<i>\$15000</i>

Teaching Experience

Teaching Assistant	<i>American University</i>
<i>STAT-616/GOVT-696 Generalized Linear Model</i>	<i>Spring 2026</i>
<i>STAT-618/GOVT-618 Bayesian Statistics</i>	<i>Fall 2025</i>
Teaching Fellow	<i>Harvard University</i>
<i>GOV 2017 Applied Bayesian Statistics for the Social Sciences</i>	<i>Spring 2025</i>
<i>GOV 2003: Quantitative Social Science Methods, II</i>	<i>Fall 2024</i>

Professional Services

Political Analysis <i>Replication Analyst</i>	<i>Fall 2023 – Summer 2024</i>
<i>Editorial Assistant</i>	<i>Fall 2022 – Summer 2024</i>
Center for Data Science <i>Graduate Student Fellow</i>	<i>Fall 2022 – Present</i>
Spring Methodology Reading Group 2024 , American University	<i>Spring 2024</i>
<i>Graduate Coordinator</i>	
Institute for Quantitative Social Science (IQSS) , Harvard University	<i>Fall 2024 – Present</i>
<i>Graduate Student Fellow</i>	
IQSS Applied Statistics Workshop , Harvard University	<i>Fall 2024 – Spring 2025</i>
<i>Graduate Coordinator</i>	

Skills

Languages: Chinese (Native), English (Fluent), German (Limited Working)
Programming: R, Python, JAGS (MCMC), LaTeX, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, Stata, SQL